

Abbreviated congressional schedule is new hurdle for Graham sanctions bill

送信者: EG US Daily 受信日時: 2026-09-03 01:37

【メール原文】

Abbreviated congressional schedule is new hurdle for Graham sanctions bill. Democratic opposition and an abbreviated congressional timeline before the

US Daily

[Customize Email Preferences](#)

Abbreviated congressional schedule is new hurdle for Graham sanctions bill

2 Sep 2026 12:34 EDT [Discover more on the Portal](#)

*

Abbreviated congressional schedule is new hurdle for Graham sanctions bill

*

Markey's primary victory keeps wind in the progressive sails

*

El-Sayed consolidating support in Michigan is positive for Democrats

*

US interceptor shortfalls are strategically significant but do not prohibit action in Iran or Taiwan

Abbreviated congressional schedule is new hurdle for Graham sanctions bill. Democratic opposition and an abbreviated congressional timeline before the midterm elections are the primary impediments to a Russia sanctions bill—which would allow the president to implement 100% tariffs on the top buyers of Russian oil and would expand and formalize sanctions on Iran—passing the House in the coming weeks.

*

We remain of the view that the Graham bill, named for the late senator Lindsey Graham, is likely to pass. But there is an increasing risk that the bill will not be brought up for a floor vote before the House recesses for the midterm campaign—which looks increasingly likely to happen earlier than anticipated, with the House having already passed a government funding patch through early December.

*

If the bill does not receive a floor vote before the next recess, that would be a negative sign for its outlook, as it would leave more time for members on the fence about the bill to shift to opposing it, based on an opposition to the Trump administration. The bill could still be brought up in the lame duck session after the midterms, but Democrats may not be inclined toward cooperating with the administration after just having flipped at least one chamber of Congress.

*

The bill would receive Trump's signature if it does pass, and the White House would retain final say on both its tariff and sanction provisions; the bill allows the administration to pause enforcement via general licenses, and the bill's 100% tariffs appear to be primarily a tool to threaten Russian oil purchasers.

Markey's primary victory keeps wind in the progressive sails. Senator Ed Markey (D-MA) easily defeated a primary challenge from Rep. Seth Moulton (D-MA) last night, winning by a thirty-point margin and sweeping the vast majority of Massachusetts's cities and towns.

*

The race is a notable entry in two key narratives in the Democratic Party this year: the strength of the progressive movement; and the push for generational change amid widespread concerns about the age of Democratic elected officials.

*

Massachusetts was an unusually clean test of the strength of these narratives. Markey will be 86 when his next term finishes, but he is also a strident progressive who co-introduced Green New Deal legislation. Moulton is a 47-year-old moderate who had pushed his party to move to the center on issues like transgender women in sports. Moreover, Massachusetts is a safe Democratic state, so electability concerns didn't intrude on the race.

*

That Markey so easily won—and that he performed best in some of Massachusetts's youngest municipalities—suggests that Democratic primary voters care more about ideological alignment than about age. If so, given the increasingly leftward lean of the Democratic electorate, that will be another factor gradually pushing the party's congressional caucuses to the left over the next primary season (see Democrats' Tea Party moment will drag the party left , 20 July 2026).

El-Sayed consolidating support in Michigan is positive for Democrats. Democrat Abdul El-Sayed has had a strong run of polling in the Michigan Senate race in the last two weeks; he hasn't trailed his Republican opponent Mike Rogers since a 13 August poll, and leads by an average of 4 points in the last five polls.

*

This is an indisputably positive sign for Democrats who had grown nervous over their chances in the race after the progressive El-Sayed won the primary over a moderate candidate in August. Michigan is nearly a must-win for Democrats, who currently hold the seat.

*

This is by no means a done deal, though. Michigan's partisan baseline probably leans about six points toward Democrats this year; if El-Sayed is leading only by four, that suggests he's still dragging Democrats down slightly, and Republican ad messaging after Labor Day will lean heavily on El-Sayed's associations with far-left figures like Hasan Piker.

*

One factor that could well be boosting El-Sayed in the race is the controversy over data centers, which is especially salient in Michigan. Whereas El-Sayed has been a strong critic of data centers, Rogers has transitioned from a pro-data-center stance to a skeptical one only in the last few weeks. With the data center issue cutting across parties, this is a significant vulnerability for Rogers.

US interceptor shortfalls are strategically significant but do not prohibit action in Iran or Taiwan. Concerns about depleted US stockpiles are unlikely to fade quickly and will be a key argument for continued increases in defense spending. At present, interceptor shortfalls limit, but do not prevent, US action in Iran or in a potential Taiwan contingency.

*

Depleted interceptors limit renewed US offensive operations against Iran to a matter of weeks, consistent with our base case of protracted standoff in the conflict (60% odds). (For more, see Standoff now likely to run through 2026 as Hormuz traffic increases , 31 August 2026.)

*

A US decision to resume offensive action beyond its current standoff posture is less likely (25% odds) and would force reliance on shorter-range, higher-risk systems that expand regional operations, raising the risk to US personnel and facilities.

*

Current shortfalls will drive defense budget debates for years but are less constraining for a Taiwan contingency than media coverage suggests. As the Pentagon reorganizes around the principle of "attritable mass," its operating concepts will reduce dependence on the interceptors now in short supply.

*

For more, please see US interceptor gaps deepen Iran standoff but have limited Taiwan effect , 2 September 2026.

Quote of the Day

"The idea that anyone represents their constituents, came here, introduces a bill to support that constituency, would do anything but vote for it is ... nuts. Could you imagine going home to your constituents and being like, 'I was trying to help you, but I had to vote no'?" - Rep. Jared Golden (D-ME) speaking to NOTUS about his decision to join Republicans on a procedural vote that set up a series of difficult votes for Democrats, including one on a resolution denouncing socialism and the DSA. Democratic House leadership is currently considering how to sanction Golden, who is leaving Congress, and the other Democrat who joined him, Rep. Marie Gluesenkamp Perez (D-WA). Sanctioning the independent-minded Glusenkamp Perez could drive another wedge between her and party leadership, but Democrats are likely to have a large enough House majority after the midterms that this won't be a serious problem for leadership.

On the Radar

10 August – 14 September: Senate on recess

8 September: Canadian retaliatory tariffs go into effect

9-10 September: GOP midterms convention

18-28 September: High-Level Week at UN General Assembly

24 September: Trump-Xi summit

30 September: Government funding runs out

3 November: National midterm elections

Clayton Allen

Practice Head, United States

+1 202.903.0027

allen@eurasiagroup.net

Noah Daponte-Smith

Senior Analyst, United States
daponte-smith@eurasiagroup.net

Kendal Walker

Senior Analyst, United States
walker@eurasiagroup.net

Jason Walter

Researcher, United States
walter@eurasiagroup.net

Reed Cohen

Analyst, Geostrategy
cohen@eurasiagroup.net

EG US Daily

unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-HG-DocID cmtka66tfhj907n1shxumskt

[Opt Out](#) | [Customize Email Preferences](#)